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Good morning everyone. I hope everyone slept well last night. My name is Shu-Kai Hsieh from National Taiwan University.

When I first entered computational linguistics more than thirty years ago, many people saw technology and the humanities as separate worlds.

Today, that separation is becoming increasingly difficult to maintain. AI systems can now read texts, generate arguments, summarize archives, and even participate in scholarly dialogue.

As someone working between AI and the humanities, I find myself asking a simple question: If machines are beginning to participate in activities that were once considered uniquely humanistic, what should the role of the humanities be in the age of AI?

My answer is not that the humanities should adapt to AI. Rather, the humanities should help shape AI itself.

In the next few minutes,, I would like to briefly share how we are exploring this question through the Humanities AI Co-Intelligence Lab, or CHAI, at NTU.

Slide 2 Why the Humanities Matter More

Many people assume that AI reduces the importance of the humanities. I would argue the opposite.

When generating text becomes almost free, language itself is no longer scarce. What becomes scarce is interpretation.

What does a text mean? Where does an idea come from? How do we evaluate competing interpretations? How do we connect a word to its historical and cultural context?

These have always been humanistic questions. The more powerful AI becomes, the more important these questions become. In short, AI creates an abundance of expression, but the humanities help us navigate meaning.

Slide 3：A Shift of Question

For the past few years, much public discussion has focused on one question: "Will AI replace us?"

I think this is the wrong question. The more important question is: "What kind of AI do we want to build?" AI should not be viewed as an oracle that ends interpretation. Instead, it can become a partner that expands interpretation.

At CHAI, we therefore think in terms of co-intelligence.

Not human intelligence. Not artificial intelligence. But intelligence emerging through collaboration.

Today I will briefly illustrate this through three examples.

Slide 4 Co-reading: Cultural Semantics Across Centuries

The first mode is co-reading.

Let me use cultural semantics as an example. Humanities scholars often work with concepts whose meanings evolve over centuries.

Words such as 情, 空, 道, or 心 are not fixed dictionary entries. They are cultural trajectories.

Traditionally, tracing these trajectories requires years of close reading. AI now allows us to examine thousands or millions of texts simultaneously. Importantly, AI is not replacing interpretation. It is helping us discover patterns that invite further interpretation.

Slide 5: Semantic Trajectories

Here we show examples such as 情 and 寂寞.

Our goal is not to ask AI for a definition. Our goal is to understand how meanings move across time. AI enables us to read at two scales simultaneously. The macro scale of centuries, and the micro scale of individual passages.

This is what we mean by co-reading. The machine helps reveal patterns. The scholar provides interpretation.

Neither works effectively alone.

Slide 6: CHAI Local Infrastructure

The second mode is co-agency.

To support humanities research, we realized that infrastructure matters. Many humanities collections involve sensitive materials, copyright concerns, institutional archives, or culturally specific resources.

For us, locality is not merely a technical issue. It is an issue of trust, autonomy, and sustainability.

That is why we are building a local-first AI environment at NTU. Our goal is to create a secure research space where scholars can work with AI without losing control of their data or intellectual processes.

Slide 7: Agentic Research Teams

Another misconception is that AI means a single chatbot.

We do not think this is the future. Human scholarship is collaborative. Different scholars play different roles.

Reading. Verification. Translation. Interpretation. Argumentation.

So we are exploring agentic teams that mirror these scholarly functions. Instead of one AI assistant, we create communities of specialized agents working together with human researchers.

In this sense, we are modeling AI not after a tool, but after a scholarly ecosystem.

Slide 8: SutraLens

This is a prototype we call SutraLens.

Think of it as a scholarly microscope. It helps researchers compare versions of texts, identify variations, trace concepts, and explore interpretive possibilities.

Again, the key point is not automation. The goal is augmentation.

We are trying to amplify scholarly attention rather than replace scholarly judgment. For humanities researchers, this distinction is crucial.

Slide 9: CHAI.md

The third mode is perhaps the most speculative.

We call it CHAI.md.

Most AI systems are defined by model weights. We are interested in another layer.

What values guide the system? What memories should it preserve? How does it handle uncertainty?

What kinds of scholarly behavior should it learn? CHAI.md is our attempt to think about AI not only as computation, but also as culture.

Slide 10: Why This Matters Beyond Research

This discussion extends beyond universities.

Increasingly, AI systems participate in education, communication, governance, and public discourse. The values embedded in those systems matter.

If East Asian languages, traditions, and intellectual perspectives are absent from their (English-centered) development, then our cultures become consumers rather than contributors.

One way to think about this is:

We are sending cultural delegates into the AI era. The question is whether those delegates carry our histories and values with them.

Slide 11: Digital Living Organism

This slide illustrates a long-term vision.

Not a product. Not a chatbot. But an evolving socio-technical organism.

One that learns from scholarship. Preserves memory. Adapts through dialogue. And remains accountable to human communities.

Whether this vision will ultimately succeed remains open. But it helps us ask new questions about the future relationship between humans and intelligent systems.

Slide 12: East Asian Humanities AI Commons

Let me conclude with one final thought.

Co-intelligence, like tea, is best cultivated slowly, attentively, and together.

East Asia possesses some of the world's richest traditions of textual scholarship, commentary, translation, and cultural memory.

These traditions are not relics of the past. They may offer important resources for imagining the future of AI.

The question before us is not whether AI will transform scholarship. It already is. The real question is whether the humanities will actively participate in shaping that transformation.

Our hope is to build an East Asian Humanities AI Commons— a shared space for language, culture, memory, and co-intelligence.

Thank you very much.